

Knut Niemann

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Tübingen	10/2019 – 12/2023
M.Sc. in Economics and Finance, University of Tübingen	10/2017 – 09/2019
B.Sc. in Economics and Business Administration, University of Tübingen	10/2012 – 09/2016

Fields of Interest

Applied macroeconomics, international economics, expectation formation, political economy

Academic Positions

Postdoctoral Researcher, Prof. Dr. Anna Gumpert, University of Tübingen	10/2023 – present
Doctoral Student, Prof. Dr. Gernot Müller, University of Tübingen	10/2019 – 06/2023

External Experience and Stays Abroad

Visiting Researcher, Danmarks Nationalbank, Copenhagen	04/2026 – 05/2026
Intern Directorate General Economics, Bundesbank, Frankfurt	05/2022 – 09/2022
Visiting Student, University of Massachusetts, Amherst	09/2014 – 05/2015

Job Market Paper

Political Distance and International Trade, [latest version](#)

Single-authored

Rising geopolitical tensions have revived concerns about trade fragmentation and its macroeconomic consequences. Yet, systematic evidence on how much political distance reduces trade is still scarce. I introduce political distance, based on UN General Assembly votes, as a novel trade cost in a structural gravity model. Using data on more than 50 years of bilateral and domestic trade among 166 countries, I estimate that an increase in political distance by the average within-pair standard deviation decreases trade by 3.1 percent, about half the effect of removing a regional trade agreement (RTA), controlling for tariffs and RTAs. The effects of past, current, and future political distance are consistent with a causal interpretation. The effect is stronger during periods of heightened political tensions and for simple-to-produce consumer goods and weaker among liberal democracies. Two counterfactuals illustrate that changes in political distance alone can have a sizable impact on real income.

An earlier version was covered in the IRC-Report on [“The EU’s Open Strategic Autonomy from a central banking perspective.”](#)

Publications

Firm expectations about their output and prices: Facts, determinants, and effects, [pub. version](#) with [Benjamin Born](#), [Zeno Enders](#), and [Gernot Müller](#), in: Rüdiger Bachmann, Giorgio Topa, and Wilbert van der Klaauw, eds., **Handbook of Economic Expectations**, Elsevier, 2022.

Working Papers

Firm Expectations and News: Micro v Macro, [latest version](#) with [Benjamin Born](#), [Zeno Enders](#), [Manuel Menkhoff](#), and [Gernot Müller](#)
Revise & Resubmit at **American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics**

To shed light on the expectation formation of firms, we use firm-level data and examine how expectations adjust to news. We classify news as either micro (firm-specific developments) or macro (information about the aggregate economy). Analysing survey data from Italian and German firms, we consistently find that expectations overreact to micro news but underreact to macro news. Our empirical specification is based on a stylized model of ‘island illusion,’ because of which firms systematically underestimate the importance of aggregate developments for their own performance. This illusion has aggregate implications, which we derive by embedding it into the canonical noisy-information model.

How US interstate migration responds to political shocks, [latest version](#) with [Jonas Adolph](#)

We study how county-level migration in the US responds to political state-level shocks. To that end, we examine how the state-level outcomes of toss-up gubernatorial elections affect county-level out-migration. Within these toss-up elections, we distinguish between counties that favoured the losing candidate (treatment) and those that favoured the winning candidate (control). We then show that there are no significant differences in the number of emigrants between treated and control counties pre-election. Post-election, emigration is five percent higher in treated counties. We find that this is mainly driven by increased out-migration from Democratic counties after a Republican win. We rationalize these results in a Roy-Borjas-type selection model with individuals who differ in political views. The model predicts that bilateral migration decreases with political distance, which we confirm empirically.

Work in progress

Tariffs and Danish Exports: Insights from Three Decades of Microdata, with [Henrik Yde Andersen](#), [Mathias Klein](#), and [Thomas Krause](#)

Presentations

- 2026 EEA-ESEM Meeting (Dublin, scheduled);
European Trade Study Group (ETSG; University of Exeter, scheduled);
XXVII Conference on International Economics (Ciudad Real; 2 papers); Danmarks
Nationalbank
- 2025 RWTH Aachen; RSIT Brown Bag (Tübingen); Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen)
- 2024 Tübingen-Hohenheim-Economics Workshop (Discussant); Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen)
- 2023 Macro Brown Bag (Tübingen, twice)
- 2022 Bundesbank internal seminars; BoE-BdF-BBk-ECB Global Economy Meeting (Eltille);
Dynare Conference (Lancaster); DFG Priority Programme 1859 online seminar

Grants and Awards

2026 Conference travel grant, Friedrich-List-Stiftung (EUR 1,000), for the XXVII Conference on International Economics, Ciudad Real, Spain

Teaching Experience

Master Thesis Supervision (6 completed, 2 ongoing)	2024–2026
Master Seminar (co-taught) 2025: 1.2 / 1.1	2024–2026
Advanced International Trade Theory (Lecture + Tutorial, Master) 2025: 1.6 / 1.2; 2026: 1.7 / 1.5	2024–2026
Firms in the Global Economy (Lecture + Tutorial, Bachelor) 2024: 2.0 / 1.3; 2025: 1.6 / 1.1	2023–2026
Bachelor Tutorials Macroeconomics I (3x), Exploratory Data Analysis, Probability and Risk, Quantitative Methods, Intermediate Microeconomics	2016–2022

Evaluations are course / instructor averages on a 1–5 scale (1 = very good, 5=insufficient).

Additional Information

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Italian (basic), French (basic)
Programming: Stata, Matlab, R, MS Office, L^AT_EX, Codex/agent AI workflows
Service: Board Member and Treasurer of SSC Tübingen e.V. since 2017 (responsible for the finances of a multi-sport club with more than 1,000 members)

References

Prof. Dr. Gernot Müller University of Tübingen Tübingen, Germany gernot.mueller@uni-tuebingen.de	Dr. Felix Strobel Bundesbank Frankfurt, Germany felix.strobel@bundesbank.de	Prof. Dr. Anna Gumpert University of Tübingen Tübingen, Germany anna.gumpert@uni-tuebingen.de
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